

Combo Scheduler: Quick Start

The Combo Scheduler makes the combo show calendar from the sign-up and conflict forms, and helps with swaps during the semester. Everything happens in one window: you click buttons, you never type commands.

First time on a computer (once)

- 1 Install Python from **python.org** (click **Downloads**, then the big yellow button, then open the file and click through). On Windows, tick **Add python.exe to PATH** on the first screen.
- 2 Put the **Combo Scheduler** program folder on this computer (e.g. in Documents), open it and double-click **Make Schedule** (on a Mac: *Make Schedule.command*; on Windows: *Make Schedule.bat*).
- 3 Mac only: if it says it can't be opened, go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway**.
- 4 The first time, a **Setup** screen appears: click **Install** and wait about a minute. The scheduler then asks for its **data folder** (it holds everything): **Choose existing folder** (e.g. the shared *Combo Scheduler data* in OneDrive), or **Make a new folder**. From now on, step 2 is all you need.

While combos sign up

- Each new combo sends you an **approval email in Outlook**. Click **Accept**, **Accept - first-year combo** or **Reject**. That's it.
- To see the combos or fix something (add or remove a member, change the liaison, withdraw a combo): **Combos** tab, click the combo, then **Actions**.

Making the schedule (once, after sign-ups close)

- 1 **Settings** tab: check the semester name (exactly as on the form, e.g. *Winter 2027*), the first and last show day, and the skip dates (reading week, holidays). Click **Save settings**. If it asks about moving last semester's files, click **Yes**.
- 2 **Run** tab, **Step 1: Check**. Read any orange or red lines: they say what to look at.
- 3 **Step 2: Make schedule**. Wait up to a minute or two.
- 4 **Schedule** tab: **Export PDF** opens the calendar. **Combos** tab: **Export PDF** opens the combo list. Print or send both.

During the semester

- **A combo can't make a show: Swaps** tab, pick the combo and the show, pick an option from the list, click **Add to pending changes**, then **Confirm changes**. The calendar PDF updates itself.
- **Emails for a night: Schedule** tab, right-click the night, **Copy student emails**, then paste into Outlook.
- **Don't click Step 2 again** once the schedule is out: it makes a brand-new schedule. **Step 3: Check** is always safe.

If something goes wrong

- Red text in the Run tab says what's wrong: read it first.
- *Something went wrong*: copy the text in the window and email it to the person in the **About** tab.
- **Open folder** (top right) shows all the files. Every saved change keeps a copy of the old schedule in *App data > Schedule backups*; past semesters are in *Archive*.
- **Back up...** (top right) now and then: the whole data folder as one zip. Keep it off this computer.
- **New computer?** Do the first-time steps again, then choose the same data folder, or **Restore from a backup**. Use one computer at a time (the app says if it is open elsewhere).